

Gemcitabine

Original Effective Date: 8/1/2022

Revision Date(s): 8/1/2022, 12/12/2022, 11/7/2023, 2/10/2025, 1/1/2026, 02/16/2026

Review Date: 02/16/2026

Policy type: Medical Necessity

Line of Business: All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Non-Preferred	No	Gemzar	J9201	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride, not otherwise specified, 200 mg
Preferred	No	Gemcitabine (Accord)	J9196	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride (accord), not therapeutically equivalent to J9201, 200 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Avgems	J9184	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride (avyxa), 200 mg

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents (or their 505(b)(2) equivalents) prior to approval of a non-preferred product.
- Preferred product requirements apply to all requests, both new starts and reauthorizations.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
 - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
 - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**
- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:

- American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow Transplantation; British Journal of Cancer; British Journal of Hematology; British Medical Journal; Cancer; Clinical Cancer Research; Drugs; European Journal of Cancer (formerly the European Journal of Cancer and Clinical Oncology); Gynecologic Oncology; International Journal of Radiation, Oncology, Biology, and Physics; The Journal of the American Medical Association, Journal of Clinical Oncology; Journal of the National Cancer Institute; Journal of the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN); Journal of Urology; Lancet; Lancet Oncology; Leukemia; The New England Journal of Medicine; Radiation Oncology;
- **Meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration;**
- Non-standard protocols may be approved based on unique clinical circumstances;
- Dose and frequency should be consistent with United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling, National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN), or indication specific peer-reviewed literature;
- In the instance that a request is made for drug(s) that was (were) previously tried (including in the same pharmacologic class or with the same mechanism of action) and such drug(s) was (were) discontinued due to a lack of efficacy the request may be subject to an off-label review for medical necessity unless supported by the NCCN or high quality literature (prospective phase 2 or 3 studies published as full manuscripts in a CMS-supported journal).

Billing

Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Avgemsi	J9184	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride (avyxa), 200 mg
Gemcitabine (Accord)	J9196	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride (accord), not therapeutically equivalent to J9201, 200 mg
Gemcitabine	J9201	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride, not otherwise specified, 200 mg

References

1. Avgemsi [package insert]. Avyxa Pharma, LLC. New Jersey. Available at: <https://dailymed.nlm.nih.gov/dailymed/fda/fdaDrugXsl.cfm?setid=e11eeff7-bcaf-4bf1-8da8-88138e01af84&type=display>
2. Gemcitabine [package insert]. Pfizer, New York, NY. Available at: https://cdn.pfizer.com/pfizercom/products/uspi_gemcitabine.pdf.
3. Gemcitabine [package insert]. Accord Healthcare, Inc., Durham, NC. Available at: https://www.accordhealthcare.us/wp-content/uploads/2022/07/Gemcitabine-RTU_PIL.pdf
4. Gemcitabine. NCCN Drugs & Biologics Compendium. Available at https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content/
5. Referenced with permission from the NCCN Clinical Practice Guidelines in Oncology (NCCN Guidelines®). National Comprehensive Cancer Network, Inc. 2025. All rights reserved. Accessed December 22, 2025. To view the most recent and complete version of the guideline, go online to NCCN.org.

Disclaimer

Drug Coverage Policies are developed as needed, reviewed and updated at least annually, and are subject to change. Other policies and coverage determination guidelines may apply. Federal and state regulatory requirements and member specific benefit plan documents, if applicable, must be reviewed prior to utilizing this Drug Coverage Policy. This Drug Coverage Policy is for informational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice nor dictate how providers should practice medicine. This policy should not be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or altered from its original form without written permission from OncoHealth, Inc.

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Date	Updates
8/01/2022	Policy created with optional step through gemcitabine (J9201).
12/12/2022	Updated formatted and updated to use universal criteria
11/7/2023	Updated Step Therapy; Addition of HCPCS; Updated references
2/10/2025	Annual review; update to policy format including universal criteria
2/17/2025	Annual review approved at P&T; update to ST criteria. Policy adopted by G.E.H.A and formatted for accessibility.
1/1/2026	Added Avgemsi, J9184, Avyxa 505(b)(2) product; removed Infugem (no longer available)
02/16/2026	Note: Infugem, J9198 (no longer available, discontinued however product may still be available until run out; HCPCS has not been retired)